

The 'operate' activity

Operate: purpose and metrics of success

Purpose

The purpose is to **maintain** and **monitor** digital products and supporting systems, ensuring optimal performance and reliability.

Success metrics

- Coverage and effectiveness of monitoring and analysis.
- Live products' reliability, performance, and information security.
- Number and impact of incidents and performance deviations.
- Adherence to the product roadmap and other relevant guidelines.
- Stakeholder satisfaction with the product and service operation.

Operate: overview

After transition, the focus shifts to operating products and systems, keeping them stable, reliable, and compliant.

How the 'operate' activity works:

- Runs platforms/systems to ensure performance and availability.
- Performs routine tests, backups, monitoring, event processing.
- Ensures that products and components operate as designed and in line with the organization's commitments to stakeholders.
- Ensures compliance with policies (continuity, security, certificates, licenses).
- Involves activities mostly invisible to customers unless issues arise.
- Proper operations prevent disruptions and ensure reliability.



Operate: practices for reliability

To strengthen reliability, operations use practices like Site Reliability Engineering (SRE) and observability, which help systems perform consistently and remain scalable.

Reliability

The ability of a product, service, or other configuration item to perform its intended function for a specified period of time or number of cycles.



Site Reliability Engineering (SRE)

A discipline that incorporates aspects of software engineering and applies them to infrastructure and operations problems. The main goal is to create scalable and highly reliable software systems.



Observability

The ability to understand the internal state of a complicated system by analysing its external outputs, such as metrics, logs, and traces.

Operate: workflow

The high-level workflow of each 'operate' activity comprises three steps:

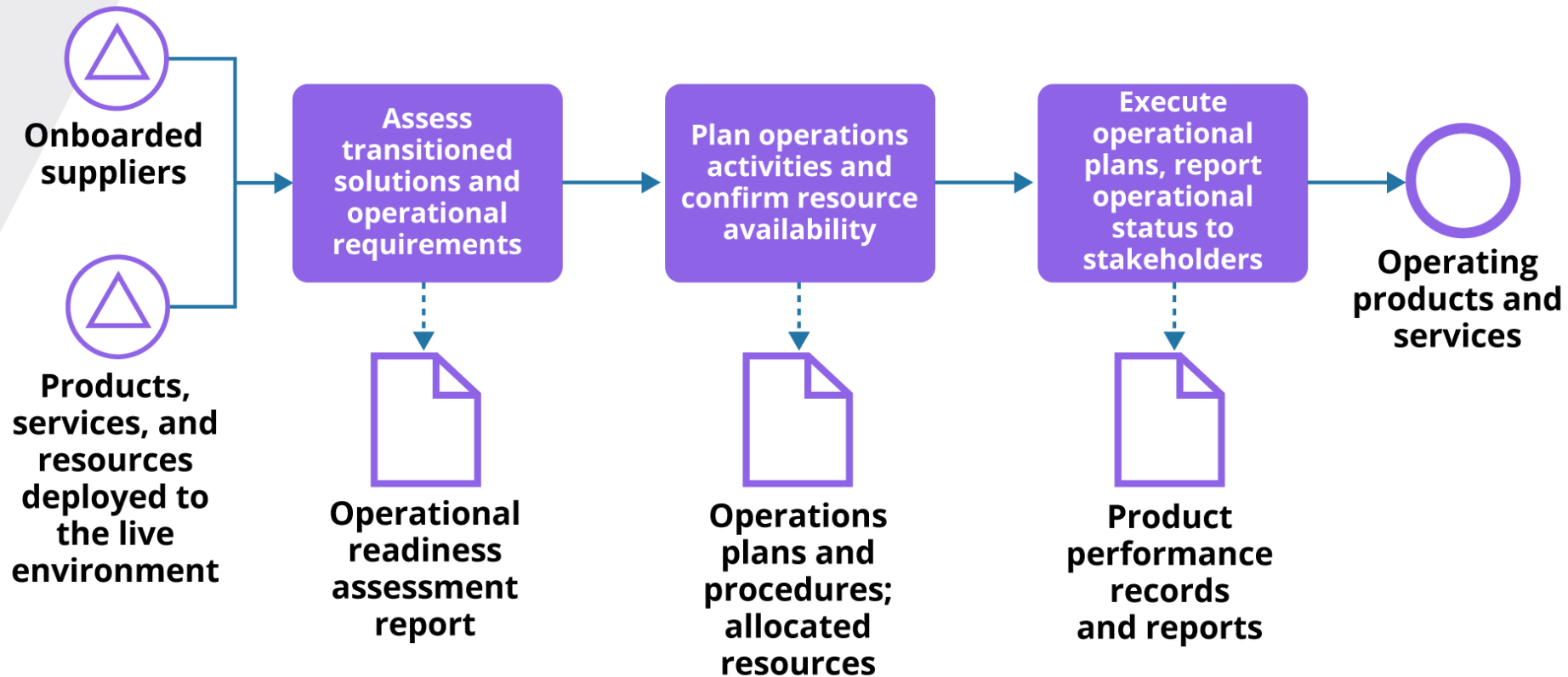


Figure 4.9 High-level workflow of the 'operate' activity

Operate: key definitions

Understanding the difference between events and incidents helps operations teams know when to monitor and when to act, ensuring reliability and quick service restoration.

Event

Any change of state that has significance for the management of a service or other configuration item.



Incident

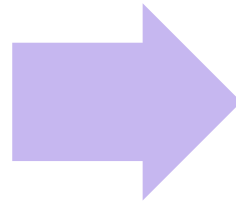
An unplanned interruption to a service or reduction in the quality of a service.



Operate: roles and outputs

Roles

- Product teams.
- IT operations teams.
- SRE teams.



Outputs

- Operating products and services.
- Product performance records and reports.

Operate: management practices

Assess transitioned solutions and operational requirements

Plan operations activities and confirm resource availability

Execute operational plans, report operational status to stakeholders

Enabling practices

Availability management	Monitoring and event management
Capacity and performance management	Problem management
Change enablement	Risk management
Continual improvement	Service continuity management
Information security management	Software development and management
Infrastructure and platform management	Supplier management
Measurement and reporting	Workforce and talent management

Supporting practices

IT asset management
Knowledge management
Service configuration management
Service financial management
Service level management

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Anna: All systems are up and running, and the new offering is ready to be delivered to customers in the cities where it is now available. You can now see it live in the updated apps.



Omar: Our AI Ops systems provide continuous monitoring of the new service, manage performance and capacity adjustments, and handle event management. We are ready for first customers.